perhaps even before the war against the other religions of the world. For over a decade and a half, the Muslim fundamentalist minority had been able to set the global agenda, while the world's moderate Muslim leaders were not doing enough, likely out of concern for their lives, to promote the alternative vision of peaceful coexistence among civilizations.

Another important insight: civilizations are the sum not only of the relations between God and man, but also of relations between the citizen and the state, the individual and the collective, rights and duties, liberty and authority, and equality and hierarchy. The significance of this insight is that in a clash of civilizations, historical variables are mixed with cultural, national, and moral elements. Even so, there is no doubt that the religious element is the dominant one, and whoever tries to sweep it under the rug is ignoring the main point.

The frequent use of the term *crusaders* by Osama bin Laden and other fundamentalist spokespeople when referring to the West emphasizes the religious aspect of the conflict. The term *crusaders* is saturated with religious connotations and contains an element of colonialism. Many Muslim speakers and writers, including Palestinians, refer to us Jews and Israelis as "crusaders," implying that we belong to a different race and have seized Palestine from the Muslims. This use of language suggests that just as the Muslim Saladin liberated Palestine from the Christian crusaders in the twelfth century, Muslims of the twenty-first century will liberate Palestine from the Jews. Fundamentalist Islam's burning hatred of the West is so great that it distorts history. It claims that the "American Crusaders" intend to conquer the "land of the two holy mosques" (meaning Saudi Arabia, home of the Muslim holy cities of Mecca and Medina) and ignores the historical fact that in five cases between the 1990s and 2015—in Kuwait, Somalia, the Balkans, Iraq, and Syria—the United States embarked on military campaigns in order to protect Muslims. On the other hand, the common denominator for the assassination of President Sadat, the "fatwa" against author Salman Rushdie, the destruction of the monumental statues of Buddha in Afghanistan and Tadmor in Syria, the executions of women and homosexuals, and the attacks on the Twin Towers was the subcivilization of fundamentalist Islam.

The American invasion of Afghanistan, the Second Gulf War, and the Israeli-Palestinian conflict marked a dramatic change from the classical doctrine of war. Western civilization now found itself in a completely